Healing Plates

THE 30-DAY ALLERGY-FREE FAMILY MEAL PLAN

Breakfast, lunch & dinner free from gluten, dairy, corn, egg, caffeine & tuna



90 family meals

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free

Finally... food the whole family can eat.

BY

Stella Efionayi

WELCOME

You are not alone



If you are holding this book, I know a little of your story. The child who eats only three foods. The nights that don't end. The family members who say “just give him bread, he'll be fine.” The quiet worry when the words haven't come yet.

I have stood in that kitchen too. **[Your story goes here — a few lines in your own words.]**

This book is the one I wish I had. No long science. No fancy ingredients you can't find. Just real food from our homes — yam, plantain, okro, rice, beans — made safe for your family, one day at a time.

You don't have to be perfect. You just have to start.

With love, Stella Efionayi

KNOW BEFORE YOU SHOP

Where allergens hide

Many “safe-looking” foods hide gluten, dairy, corn or caffeine. Here is where they hide — especially in our African kitchens.

Avoid	Where it hides
Gluten	Bread, semovita, wheat swallow, chin chin, puff-puff, meat pie, pasta, **Milo, Bournvita & Ovaltine** (barley malt), soy sauce, many stock cubes
Dairy	Peak/Three Crowns milk, butter, cheese, yogurt, ice cream, whey, casein, “non-dairy” creamers that contain casein
Corn	**Pap/ogi/akamu**, kenkey, banku, tuwo masara, ugali, pap (SA), custard powder, cornflour, popcorn, **baking powder** (corn starch), glucose syrup, xanthan gum, many gluten-free flour blends
Egg	Cakes, mayonnaise, some pasta, egg rolls, meat pies, many “gluten-free” breads and pancake mixes
Caffeine	Tea (black & green), coffee, matcha, cola, energy drinks, **kola nut**, chocolate & cocoa, Milo
Tuna	Canned tuna, tuna salad, some sandwiches, sushi and fish pies
Pork	Bacon, ham, sausages, lard, gelatine (sweets & jelly), some suya

The 10-second label rule

Turn the pack over. Read the ingredients **every time** — brands change their recipes. If you can't pronounce it, or it says “may contain”, leave it on the shelf.

5 steps to healing the gut

When the gut is out of balance, everything feels harder — sleep, moods, toilet troubles and picky eating. These 5 steps are the heart of this book.

1

Remove the irritants

Dairy, gluten, fried food, cookies, bread, processed food, refined sugar, corn, pap and garri.
Swap: dairy → coconut; flour → tapioca, potato or buckwheat flour.

2

Support digestion with healing nutrients

Zinc and magnesium from leafy vegetables and pumpkin seeds.

3

Repair the gut

Keep the gut hydrated and nourished: berries, psyllium husk, okro stew, egusi soup (no tripe or intestine).

4

Knock down the bad bugs

Garlic, onions, rosemary, thyme, potatoes, carrots, courgette, pumpkin, coconut yogurt, green banana and gluten-free oats.

5

[Step 5 — waiting for your notes]

Send me the fifth step and it goes here.

Picky eating is not bad behaviour

A child who eats only three foods is often a child whose nervous system feels unsafe. Go gently. One new food at a time, next to a food they already love.

YOUR MONTH AT A GLANCE

Week 1

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
B Yam & ugu sauce	B Millet hausa koko	B Plantain & sweet potato hash	B Buckwheat banana pancakes	B Yam porridge (asaro)	B Coconut rice porridge	B Avocado sweet potato toast
L Okro soup & pounded yam	L Jollof rice & chicken	L Beans & ripe plantain	L Egusi soup & amala	L Sweet potato lentil soup	L Waakye & fish stew	L Kenyan pilau & kachumbari
D Coriander pepper fish	D Chicken pepper soup	D Roast chicken & root veg	D Sukuma wiki & beef	D Egg-free moi moi & salad	D Turkey meatballs & lentil pasta	D Green plantain porridge

TICK AS YOU SHOP

Week 1 shopping list

Everything for Days 1–7. Cross off what you already have.

Vegetables & greens

- [ ] Ugu or spinach (3 bunches)
- [ ] Okro (15)
- [ ] Fresh tomatoes (8)
- [ ] Onions (6)
- [ ] Sweet potatoes (4)
- [ ] Cucumber (2)
- [ ] Garlic (1 bulb)

Roots & fruit

- [ ] Yam (1 large)
- [ ] Green plantain (4)
- [ ] Ripe plantain (4)
- [ ] Blueberries
- [ ] Mango (2)
- [ ] Lemons (3)

Protein

- [ ] Chicken (1.5 kg)
- [ ] Mackerel or tilapia (4 small)
- [ ] Beef (500 g)
- [ ] Turkey mince (500 g)
- [ ] Brown or black-eyed beans (2 cups)

Pantry

- [ ] Unrefined red palm oil
- [ ] Extra virgin olive oil
- [ ] Ground crayfish
- [ ] Buckwheat flour
- [ ] Tapioca flour
- [ ] Millet
- [ ] Rice
- [ ] Coconut milk (2 tins)

Herbs & spices

- [ ] Fresh coriander
- [ ] Thyme
- [ ] Ata rodo / scotch bonnet
- [ ] Curry powder (no fillers)
- [ ] Sea salt

WEEK 1

Day 1

"Small changes, one plate at a time. You are doing better than you think."

BREAKFAST Boiled Yam with Ugu & Tomato Sauce

30 min

YOU NEED

- ☐ ½ medium yam, peeled & sliced
- ☐ 2 cups ugu (or spinach), chopped
- ☐ 3 fresh tomatoes, chopped
- ☐ 1 onion, sliced
- ☐ 2 tbsp unrefined red palm oil
- ☐ ¼ tsp ground crayfish (optional)
- ☐ Pinch of salt

STEPS

1. Boil the yam in salted water for 15–20 min until soft.
2. Warm the palm oil gently — don't let it smoke. Add onion, cook 2 min.
3. Add tomatoes and crayfish. Cook 5 min.
4. Stir in the ugu, cook 2 min, then turn off the heat.
5. Spoon the sauce over the yam.

Why it helps: Yam gives slow, steady energy. Ugu is rich in iron and magnesium.

Swap it: No yam? Use sweet potato. No ugu? Use spinach, kale or sukuma wiki.

LUNCH Okro Soup with Chicken & Pounded Yam

40 min

YOU NEED

- ☐ 500 g chicken pieces
- ☐ 15 fresh okro, chopped
- ☐ 1 cup ugu or spinach
- ☐ 1 onion, 2 ata rodo peppers
- ☐ 1 tbsp ground crayfish
- ☐ 2 tbsp red palm oil, salt
- ☐ Pounded yam or amala, to serve

STEPS

1. Season chicken with onion and salt. Cook in 2 cups water for 20 min.
2. Add palm oil, pepper and crayfish. Cook 5 min.
3. Add okro and cook only 3–4 min so it stays green.
4. Stir in the greens and turn off the heat.
5. Serve with pounded yam.

Why it helps: Okro is soft and gentle on the gut and helps keep things moving.

Kid tip: Picky eater? Blend the okro smooth so there are no "slimy bits" to see.

DINNER Coriander Pepper Fish & Green Plantain

35 min

YOU NEED

- ☐ 4 small mackerel (titus) or tilapia
- ☐ 3 green (unripe) plantains
- ☐ 1 handful fresh coriander
- ☐ 2 garlic cloves, 1 small onion
- ☐ 1 scotch bonnet (skip for kids)
- ☐ 1 tbsp olive oil, juice of 1 lemon, salt

STEPS

1. Blend coriander, garlic, onion, pepper, oil, lemon and salt to a paste.
2. Rub the paste over the fish. Rest 15 min.
3. Bake on parchment at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20–25 min (no foil).
4. Meanwhile, peel and boil the plantains for 20 min.
5. Serve with sliced cucumber.

Why it helps: Small fish carry far less mercury than tuna. Green plantain feeds good gut bacteria.

MAKE SHOPPING EASIER

Allergy-friendly brands near you

Always read the label — brands can change their recipes. Many gluten-free products still contain corn or egg.

Nigeria

Swallows: Ola-Ola & Iyan Ado pounded yam flour, plantain flour

Rice: Ofada, Mama Gold, Royal Stallion

Dairy-free: Kara or Chaokoh coconut milk, homemade tigernut milk (kunu aya)

Oils: Figaro extra virgin olive oil, unrefined red palm oil

Shops: Spar, Prince Ebeano, Justrite, Grand Square, local markets

Ghana

Swallows: Pure cassava or plantain fufu flour (no corn), yam flour

Dairy-free: Coconut milk, homemade tigernut milk

Drinks: Sobolo (no sugar), ginger, coconut water

Shops: Melcom, MaxMart, Shoprite, Makola market

Kenya

Flours: Pure wimbi (finger millet) or sorghum flour — check no maize is added

Dairy-free: Kara coconut milk, coconut cream

Drinks: Ginger-lemongrass “chai” without tea leaves

Shops: Naivas, Quickmart, Carrefour, Chandarana

South Africa

Dairy-free: Oh Mylk, Alpro, Rhodes coconut milk

Drinks: Freshpak Rooibos (naturally caffeine-free)

Pantry: Nature's Choice, Bob's Red Mill gluten-free

Shops: Woolworths, Checkers, Dis-Chem, Faithful to Nature

United Kingdom

Dairy-free: Koko, Alpro, The Coconut Collaborative, Violife

African foods: Tropical Sun yam, plantain & cassava flours

Sauces: Free & Easy

Shops: Tesco & Sainsbury's Free From, Holland & Barrett, African shops

USA & Canada

Flours: Otto's Naturals cassava flour, Bob's Red Mill gluten-free

Dairy-free: So Delicious, Cocojune, Daiya, Earth's Own

Snacks: Enjoy Life, MadeGood

Shops: Whole Foods, Loblaws (PC Free From), Thrive Market

Healing Lunch Box

BONUS BOOK 1

30 Days of Allergy-Free School Lunches & Snacks Kids Will Actually Eat



30 lunch boxes

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free | Nut-free

Nut-free and school-safe.

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DAY 1 Sweet Potato Chicken Bites Box

Nut-free
Prep the night before

YOU NEED

- [ ] 6–8 sweet potato chicken bites
- [ ] Cucumber sticks
- [ ] Mango slices
- [ ] Small pot of coconut yogurt (dip)

STEPS

1. Mash 1 boiled sweet potato with 1 cup shredded cooked chicken, pinch of salt & thyme.
2. Stir in 2 tbsp tapioca flour. Roll into small balls and flatten.
3. Bake at 200 °C / 400 °F for 20 min. Cool and refrigerate.
4. Morning: pack the bites, cucumber, mango and the dip.

Why it helps: Protein + slow carbs keep energy steady through the school day.

Parent tip: Pack one food they already love next to the new one. No pressure.

DAY 2 Mini Jollof Rice & Chicken Box

Nut-free
Use leftovers

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 cup leftover jollof rice
- [ ] 3–4 pieces baked chicken
- [ ] Carrot sticks
- [ ] Watermelon cubes

STEPS

1. Warm the jollof rice and chicken in the morning.
2. Pack into a thermos to keep warm until lunch.
3. Add carrot sticks and watermelon in a separate section.

Why it helps: A familiar home favourite makes lunchtime feel safe for sensitive eaters.

Time saver: Cook extra jollof at dinner — tomorrow's lunch is already done.

Healing Sips

BONUS BOOK 2

The 30-Day Gentle Detox & Juicing Plan for the Whole Family



30 detox recipes

Gluten-free | Dairy-free | Corn-free | Egg-free | Caffeine-free | Tuna-free | Pork-free

One gentle glass a day.

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DAY 1 The Daily Detox Smoothie

Author's recipe
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] 1 celery stick
- [ ] ½ green apple
- [ ] Handful of blueberries
- [ ] 1 tbsp fresh coriander (cilantro)
- [ ] 1 tbsp fresh parsley
- [ ] 1 cup water (or more)

STEPS

1. Wash everything well.
2. Blend until smooth.
3. Drink fresh, in the morning.

Gentle daily cleanse · Bowels · Hydration · Antioxidants

Why it helps: Celery is the base. Apple adds fibre. Coriander and parsley are traditional cleansing herbs.

Go slowly: Children: start with half a cup. Detox should be slow and gentle.

DAY 2 Boosted Detox Smoothie

Author's recipe
5 min

YOU NEED

- [ ] Everything from Day 1
- [ ] ¼ tsp spirulina powder
- [ ] ¼ tsp lion's mane powder
- [ ] Brahmi (bacopa) — adults only

STEPS

1. Make the Day 1 smoothie.
2. Add the spirulina and lion's mane.
3. Blend again and drink fresh.

Brain & focus · Mould & yeast support · Energy

Why it helps: Spirulina is rich in iron and protein. Lion's mane is a mushroom traditionally used for focus.

Safety first: Ask your child's doctor before adding any herb or supplement, especially with medication.